

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION

LabHive Platform User Guide

Complete Reference for Lab Managers

Version 3.0 — October 2026

Lab Management Platform

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SECTION 01

🚀 Getting Started

Signing in, finding your way around, and getting help

Signing in

LabHive runs in any modern browser — nothing to install. Go to:

> **Address:** https://labhive.app/app

1. Enter the **email** and **password** your administrator gave you, then click **Sign in** .
2. The first time, you are asked to choose a new password before you can continue.
3. Leave **"Keep me signed in on this device"** ticked on a computer only you use. Untick it on a shared one.
4. If the Terms of Service have changed since you last signed in, you are asked to accept them once.

> **Forgot your password?** Ask your org admin to reset it, or use **Contact Us** on the sign-in page.

> **One person, two roles:** someone who is both a lab manager and a lab user has two accounts on the same email. They sign in once; each account keeps its own permissions.

Dashboard & sidebar

After signing in you land on the **Dashboard**: one card per module you can use. Click a card to open it.

🎓

Training Records

Safety, documents, vehicle, equipment, alarm, locker and exam — per lab user.

👥

Lab Management

Lab users, lab managers, account requests and data export.

🧪

Project Workspace

📅

Booking Equipment

Projects, sub projects, material folders, reductions and labels.

The shared booking calendar, approvals and booking rules.

🔧

Equipment & Maintenance

The equipment list, maintenance records and who may see each item.

📚

Equipment SOP

SOPs, training videos, standards and exams per instrument.

📋

Task Board

Tasks, meetings, timeline and daily reminders.

📦

Supply Inventory

Room-by-room supply counts and reports.

💬

Lab Messages

Conversations kept as threads, with attachments.

🔲

QR Labels

Print equipment and material labels.

Choose which cards appear in **Profile → Dashboard Icons**.

The **left sidebar** shows the tabs of the module you are in. Below them, **Apps** switches between modules, and **Home** returns to the dashboard. On some screens the lower part of the sidebar holds that screen's own panel instead — for example the equipment picker in Booking, or the project info on a project's folders page. On a phone, the menu button at the top left opens the sidebar.

Notifications, tours & help

- 🔔 **Bell** (top right) — your notifications: bookings, training decisions, tasks, messages, locker requests and more. Click one to go straight to it.
- **? (top right) — Guided tours.** A list of step-by-step tours: the *Website tour* and the *Booking Equipment* tour. Take any of them again whenever you like.
- **? on each page** — help and tips for that page. While a page's green tip banner is showing, its **?** sits at the right of the banner.
- **Sara** (bottom right) — answers common questions. Use **Report a problem** there to send a description and a screenshot to the administrators.

> **New lab users** get the Booking Equipment tour by themselves the first time they open Booking. It stops once they skip it or finish it.

SECTION 02

👥 Lab Management

The people in your lab, account requests, and data export

Tabs: **Lab Users** | **Import lab users** | **Lab Managers** | **Organization Admins** | **Approval Requests** | **Export Data** | **Lab Manager Guide**

Lab users & lab managers

Lab Management → Lab Users / Lab Managers

- **Add** — enter name and email. A temporary password is made and emailed; the person must choose a new one at their first sign-in.
- **Edit** — details, assigned projects, required safety steps and yearly re-safety. **Icons** narrows which dashboard icons the person gets.
- **Cards / List** — switch views above the list; filter by advisor, or sort by advisor to group people under each one. The list shows each person's email, safety progress and whether they have signed in.
- **Deactivate** — the person can no longer sign in; their records are kept. **Delete** removes the account.
- Adding someone whose email already has an account (for example a lab user who becomes a lab manager) links the new account to the same sign-in.

> **Organization Admins** are shown read-only to lab managers. Only an org admin (or the super admin) can change an org admin's account.

Import lab users from Excel

Lab Management → Import lab users

- **Download the template**, fill in first name, last name, email and director / advisor / supervisor / manager, and upload it. **Up to 50 lab users per file** — split a longer list into several files.
- **Review the list**: edit any cell, remove or add a row, and tick the safety steps each person must do (Step 1 / 2 / 3 / 4) and **Yearly re-safety**. An unticked step is not required. A row whose email already has an account is shown in red and blocks the import until you remove or change it. Nothing is sent at this stage; **Save and finish later** keeps the list (for you and the other lab managers) to continue from the history.
- **Confirm** — accounts are made only now — then choose to send the welcome email (sign-in email + temporary password) **now** or on a **date and time** you pick (Chicago time) — or **Save and finish later** and send it from the import in the history (**Welcome emails: choose when**).
- **Edit list** on an import reopens its table: change names, supervisor, safety steps and yearly re-safety for anyone; change the email or remove a person only until they sign in.

- Imported lab users' safety steps are approved by a lab manager, the same as for anyone else.
- The **history** lists every import: who got the email, who has signed in and chosen their own password, and their safety progress. Scheduled emails can be sent now or moved; **Resend email** makes a new temporary password for someone who has not signed in.

Approval requests

Lab Management → Approval Requests

Requests to **delete an account** appear here. Before approving, choose who takes over that person's records, so nothing they own is lost. A count of pending requests shows at the top of Lab Management.

Export data

Lab Management → Export Data

Downloads one ZIP with a folder per person (lab users and lab managers separately). Each folder holds an Excel workbook — profile, every training record, bookings in the date range you choose, projects and materials — and the files they uploaded, sorted by source. Project folders hold a workbook per project and one folder per material. Anything that could not be included is listed on screen with the reason.

SECTION 03

🎓 Training Records

Everything a lab user completes and keeps current

Training Records opens on a grid of lab user cards. **Click a card** to open that person's records, then use the tabs inside the panel. The mark on each tab shows ✓ done, ⏳ waiting, or — not started. Switch **This user / All users** to see everyone's records at once — the audit view.

> **Privacy:** a lab user's training records are visible only to them and to the lab managers and admins of their organization. A lab user can never approve their own records.

🦺 Safety

New lab users complete the safety steps in order. You can set which steps a person must do.

- Approve each step when it is submitted. After an approval, a bar names the next step.
- **Some modules stay locked** for a lab user until their safety training is approved.
- **Yearly re-safety:** every **Sep 1** each lab user with Yearly re-safety ticked (all lab users, unless you untick it in their Edit box) must complete their safety steps again, each approved by a lab manager, and LabHive locks for them until they do. To excuse someone after Sep 1, untick their steps in Lab Management → Lab Users → Edit.

📄 Lab User Documents

Certificates the lab user uploads (and copies of their signed forms). Each shows its status; click **Approve** on a pending one.

🚗 Vehicle

Vehicle training records for people who drive lab vehicles: date, trainer and confirmation.

> Vehicle and building-alarm training dates cannot be edited once confirmed.

🔧 Equipment & retraining

Training per instrument, and the equipment exams passed. Equipment that needs training cannot be booked until it is approved. Equipment a lab user has **not used for 3 months** needs retraining: it is greyed out in Booking until the retraining is approved.

🗄️ Lab User Locker

- Lab users see only their own locker. Without one, they press **Request a locker** (with an optional note).
- You get a notification. The **Locker requests** box above the locker grid lists who is waiting; pick a free locker and **Assign**, or **Decline**. The request also shows on that person's Locker tab.
- Mark lockers **Unavailable** in the grid; the All Lockers table lists every assignment.

🔔 Building Alarm, 📝 Exam

- **Building Alarm** — record alarm training, required for after-hours access.
- **Exam** — equipment exam results: score, pass/fail and date.

SECTION 04

🔧 Equipment & Maintenance

The equipment list, its records, and what lab users may see

Tabs: **List of Equipment** | **Calibration** | **Maintenance Records** | **Settings**

Adding or editing equipment

1. Click **+ Add equipment** (or **Import Excel** to load a whole list).
2. Enter name, nickname, category, location, manufacturer, serial number, date received and condition. Setting the condition to **Out of Service** marks it unusable.
3. Tick **Responsible for Maintenance** — each lab manager is listed once — and whether they get maintenance reminders.
4. Choose **Lab user access** (required):
   - **Calibration & maintenance** → *Lab only*: hidden from lab users, and from the SOP and booking lists for everyone unless "Show lab-only equipment" is turned on.
   - Or the areas lab users may use: **Equipment SOP**, **Booking calendar**, **Request training**, **Exam**. Unticking Request training means no training record is needed to book it.
5. Save. An item with no choice yet shows **Waiting for decision**.

Maintenance Records shows usage hours from bookings and the maintenance history. **Calibration** holds calibration dates and records. **Settings** holds the equipment categories.

SECTION 05

📚 Equipment SOP

SOPs, videos, standards and exams for each instrument

- Pick an instrument, then add or update its **SOP**, **training videos**, **standards** and **exam** questions.
- **An instrument that runs several tests** (for example DSR and MSCR on one rheometer): press **+ Add test** on the SOP card or the Exam tab. Each test has its own pill, SOP and exam. A lab user ticks the tests they need when requesting training, and only those exams must be passed before you can confirm the training.
- Each exam question can have an **Explanation**. Lab users see the right answer and the explanation straight after answering. An uploaded exam file can include a line starting **Explanation:** under each question.
- Lab users see videos and SOPs once their training for that instrument is approved, or with **temporary access** you grant.
- **SOP Notes** — lab users leave feedback or suggest improvements.
- Lab-only equipment is hidden here for everyone. Lab managers and admins can turn on **Show lab-only equipment**.

Equipment QR labels

Scanning an equipment's QR label opens a page with its **SOP**, **Book**, **Contact** and **Calibration** options, after signing in. Options a lab user may not use for that item are hidden.

SECTION 06

Booking Equipment

The shared booking calendar and its rules

Tabs: **Book Equipment** | **History & Usage** | **Special Treatment** | **Settings** (admins)

Who can book what

- **TRAINING REQUIRED** — greyed out; a lab user cannot select it until their training is approved.
- **RETRAIN** — not used for 3 months; greyed out until the retraining is approved.
- Bookings are in the booker's own name. **Lab users cannot book for someone else.** Lab managers can, with *Book on behalf of* in the booking form.

Making a booking

1. Tick one or more instruments in the sidebar (**Select all** shows every booking on one calendar).
2. With several ticked, choose **Same time for all** (one drag books them all) or **One by one** (a time for each).
3. **Drag** down on the calendar to pick the day and time. Past times cannot be booked.
4. Choose the **purpose** — Project, Thesis or Other — and tick **"I am responsible for this booking and confirm it is for the purpose selected."** Both are required.
5. After booking, add it to **Google Calendar**, **Outlook**, or download an **.ics** file.

Choosing a layout

Layout, above the calendar, changes how bookings are drawn. Everyone starts on Classic; once a person picks another it is saved to their account and follows them to any computer.

- **Classic** — the Day / Week / Month calendar described above. Bookings over several days sit in the *Multi-day* band under the dates; when many bookings overlap they are listed in one block (*+ more* shows everyone). Up to 3 side by side in Week (6 in Day) can still be dragged to move them.
- **Timeline** — one row per instrument; every booking shows who booked it, the time and the purpose, so it stays readable with **Select all**. In **Day**, drag along a row to book that instrument, or down across rows to book several at the same time. Lab managers and admins can switch *Rows* to *People* to see what each person is using.
- **Agenda** — every booking of the week in time order, with a search box.

In every layout, point at a booking for its details and click it to open it.

Approving, moving & cancelling

- Equipment set to *Requires Approval* creates **pending** bookings. Click one, then **Approve** or **Deny** with a reason; the booker is notified.
- **Move** a booking by dragging it; drag its top or bottom edge to change the time. A lab user can move only their own.
- **Cancel** is possible until the booking starts. Lab users should cancel what they will not use, so others can book it.
- **Edit** is possible until it ends; a booking in progress can be extended. **A finished booking is locked** — only admins can correct it.
- **View lab user** (above the calendar) shows one person's bookings.
- Some equipment asks for photos of the area **before and after use**; missing photos can block that person's future bookings.

History, special treatment & settings

- **History & Usage** — past bookings, with CSV export. The usage summary shows the six busiest instruments; **Show all** lists every one with its hours.
- **Special Treatment** — instructions shown to anyone booking that equipment, which they must confirm before booking.
- **Settings** (admins) — which equipment can be booked, and which needs approval.

SECTION 07

📋 Task Board

Tasks, meetings, deadlines and reminders

Tabs: **Overview** **My Tasks** **Team** **Calendar** **Timeline** **Meetings** **Reminders** **Assign Others** (admins)

- **My Tasks** — add a task with a deadline, priority and project; click its status circle to move it along. Moving a task to done sets it to 100%. Private tasks are hidden from teammates.
- **Out of Lab** (My Tasks sidebar) — mark days you will be away; they show as a red ✕ on the calendars.
- **Team** — every lab manager's tasks on one board.
- **Timeline** — each task as a bar from start to deadline, grouped by project. Link tasks ("waits on") to see the **critical path** — the chain that decides the finish date. Tasks without dates are listed as Undated.
- **Meetings** — schedule a meeting, then add action items for that date; the live drawing board lets you sketch together.
- **Reminders** — tick *Remind me daily* on a task to get a reminder every morning at 7am until it is done (it does not start before the task's start date).

SECTION 08

📦 Supply Inventory

Room-by-room supply counts and reports

Tabs: **Inspection** **Export Data** **Rooms** **Supplies** **Import** **Settings**

1. **Inspection** — pick a room and count each supply. The box starts at the last count (grey); leave it untouched to keep that number.
2. A count below the minimum asks how many need ordering before you move on.
3. On the results screen, **Save & next room** starts the next room that has supplies.

- **Export Data** — one inspection or the full history, as Excel or PDF, with clickable purchase links. **Edit** corrects a count afterwards.
- **Rooms / Supplies** — card grids with photos; supplies are grouped by room. Each supply has a unit and a minimum. **Import** loads a list from Excel.

SECTION 09

💬 Lab Messages

Conversations kept as threads

- Start a message, then reply inside its thread; attach a file or photo to a message or a reply.
- You are told about replies in the app, and by email if you turn that on in **Profile → Notifications**.
- Choose a background for the message board.

SECTION 10

🧪 Project Workspace

Projects, sub projects, material folders, reductions and labels

Sidebar: **Material Inventory** **Tested Materials** **Manage Projects** **Material Types** **Project Test Results** **Workspace** **Project Members**

The **Projects · Materials · Search** row switches between project cards, every material, and search. Lab users see the projects they are assigned to. **Manage Projects** creates projects and assigns lab users; **Material Types** sets the types offered when adding a material.

Sub projects

A project can be split into **sub projects** (optional), such as MIX or #2:

```
project → sub project → material folder → reductions
```

- Open a project and its **Sub projects** tab. Add sub projects (up to 20 characters — the name is printed on the label), then tick the material folders that belong to each and click **Save changes**.
- A folder can be in **several** sub projects; it then gets its own colour wherever it appears. Folders not ticked anywhere stay on the main project.
- A project without sub projects shows a one-time "New: sub projects" message to everyone who can work on it.
- A sub project can be removed only once no folder is connected to it.

Materials & folders

- Open a project card; **Add material to …** appears. The first question is **Sub project** (required, main project last). The rest — name, PI, type, source, quantity, location, dates and photos — is as before.
- Editing a material shows its sub projects as tick boxes.
- The small sign beside **2 · Project Materials** opens the **folders page**: project → sub projects → folders → reductions as a tree, with the project info in the left sidebar. Click a folder to see its details below.
- **Non-Project Material** (Materials view) is for material that belongs to no project.

Material reduction

Material Reduction splits a material into new ones — for example fractionation into sieve sizes. Each fraction becomes its own material, with its own barcode, quantity, location and label, listed under its parent's **Material Reduction** tab (never as a separate card). Fractions follow their parent's sub projects.

Labels & tested samples

- Every material has a printable **4×6 label** with its own barcode and QR code. It lists Project info (with the sub project), Original Material, and — on a reduction — Reduced Material.
- A **tested sample** gets its own label and identity: use the **Tested** pill (one label for samples from one or more projects), or the *Tested materials label* tab on a material. **Tested Materials** in the sidebar lists them all.
- **Project Test Results** — record results and attach their files. **Workspace** — charts and analysis of the results. **Project Members** — team up so you share project data.

SECTION 11

🔲 QR Labels

Print equipment and material labels

Tabs: **Equipment Barcode** | **Records** | **Material Labels** | **Summary**

- **Equipment Barcode** — make and print a QR label for an instrument. Labels print in black and white on any printer.
- **Records** — pick several instruments and print their labels together.
- **Material Labels** — print or reprint a project material's 4×6 label.
- **Summary** — materials by type across projects.

SECTION 12

👤 Profile & Account Settings

Your details, password, dashboard and notifications

Click your name at the top right, or the Profile card.

- **My Info** — name, nickname, photo or avatar, and contact details.
- **Password** — change your password (at least 6 characters).
- **Dashboard Icons** — choose which cards appear on your dashboard. You can only choose from the modules your organization has given you.
- **Notifications** — for each kind of event, choose in-app and/or email: bookings, training decisions, tasks and comments, meetings, deadline and daily reminders, messages, icons granted, and invitations.
- **Storage** — where your personal files are saved: LabHive cloud, Google Drive, OneDrive, or your own server (WebDAV). Only future uploads move.
- **Delete Account** — ask for your account to be removed; an admin reviews the request.

QUICK REFERENCE

★ Common Tasks

Where to go for the everyday jobs

Task	Where
Add a lab user	Lab Management → Lab Users → Add
Add many lab users from Excel	Lab Management → Import lab users
Approve a certificate	Training Records → the person's card → Lab User Documents
Approve a safety step	Training Records → the person's card → Safety
Assign a locker	Training Records → Lab User Locker → Locker requests → Assign
Approve or deny a booking	Booking Equipment → click the pending booking
Decide what lab users see of an instrument	Equipment & Maintenance → Edit → Lab user access
Add a sub project	Project Workspace → open the project → Sub projects
Split a material by sieve size	Project Workspace → open the project → Material Reduction
Print a material label	The material → its label tab, or QR Labels → Material Labels
Export everyone's records	Lab Management → Export Data
Run a supply inspection	Supply Inventory → Inspection
Take a guided tour again	The ? at the top right → Guided tours
Report a problem	Sara (bottom right) → Report a problem



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Lab Management Platform

For support, visit **https://labhive.app/app/?support=1**